

EXCAVATION SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Control collapse, underground utilities and heavy equipment hazards.

8-10 MINUTES

OBJECTIVE

Prevent trench collapse, utility strikes, falls and equipment hazards during excavation work.

TOPIC EXPLANATION

- Verify permits and underground utilities before excavation.
- Provide sloping, shoring or trench boxes where required.
- Inspect excavations daily and after weather or ground changes.

REALISTIC SITE SCENARIO

- Workers entered an unsupported trench.
- The sidewall collapsed after equipment vibration.
- Proper trench protection would have prevented the incident.

REMEMBER

Never enter an unprotected excavation.

EXCAVATION SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Hazards, control measures and daily pre-work verification.

8-10 MINUTES

KEY HAZARDS

- Collapse
- Underground utilities
- Flooding
- Heavy equipment
- Falls
- Falling material
- Poor access
- Atmospheric hazards

CONTROL MEASURES

- Verify permit.
- Locate underground services.
- Use trench protection.
- Provide ladders.
- Barricade excavation.
- Keep spoil away from edge.
- Maintain equipment clearance.
- Inspect after rain.
- Gas test if required.
- Prepare emergency plan.

SUPERVISOR TALKING SCRIPT

No one will enter an excavation until permits, trench protection and access have been verified.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- Is the permit approved?
- Are utilities identified?
- Is trench protection installed?
- Is access safe?
- Is barricading complete?
- What is the emergency escape route?

VERIFY BEFORE STARTING TODAY

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Permit approved | ☐ Utilities identified |
| ☐ Protection installed | ☐ Ladder available |
| ☐ Barricaded | ☐ Ground stable |
| ☐ Gas checked | ☐ Equipment clear |
| ☐ Standby ready | ☐ Emergency plan |

ATTENDANCE AND APPROVAL

EXCAVATION SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

Project / Site

Date

Presented by

Work area

No	Full Name	Company / Role	Signature
1			
2			
3			
4			
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Supervisor notes